

Chapter 132-1

Zhao Xuning had just finished assisting with a surgery and came out of the operating room to take off her sterile gown.

Before she even had time to wash her hands, she overheard people chatting nearby.

"Those two downstairs are so beautiful."

"Watching them makes me want to fall in love too... What kind of idol drama come to life is this?"

"What are you all talking about?" someone asked, confused.

"The patient from the seventeenth floor. She ran out as soon as she woke up and happened to run into her wife downstairs."

"Today happens to be the first snow too! Kissing in the snow—it's so romantic I could die from shipping them."¹

"If I remember correctly, the patient on the seventeenth floor seems to be Dr. Zhao's friend."

"....."

A nurse poked the person who was talking beside her. Zhao Xuning happened to be passing by.

The topic came to an abrupt halt, and there was even some awkwardness in the air.

The nurses exchanged glances with each other.

Zhao Xuning adjusted her glasses, maintaining her cool and aloof demeanor. "The patient on seventeen woke up?"

Someone answered nervously: "Just woke up. She's downstairs now."

Zhao Xuning: "Oh."

Her tone was always detached. When she first arrived at the hospital, she had rejected quite a few doctors and nurses who tried to chat her up.

She claimed she didn't do office romances.

People from other departments also tried to approach her, but she said the medical field was too busy, and she didn't really like dating colleagues.

She basically rejected everyone without offending them.

She had always been a loner at the hospital, without any close friends.

Mainly because Zhao Xuning was young, yet her position was not low.

In all the hospitals in Haizhou City, she was the only one who had reached such a position at her age.

Most medical students were already nearly thirty by the time they finished their studies. Even with an eight-year combined bachelor's-master's-doctoral program, they still had to slowly work their way up at the hospital after graduating.

Yet Zhao Xuning was exceptionally good at creating miracles.

This was also why no one dared to treat her like a newly arrived doctor—jokes and teasing were rare.

Geniuses always had a sense of distance from ordinary people.

On top of that, all of Zhao Xuning's casual clothes were designer brands—definitely not something a newly graduated medical student could afford. The car she drove to work cost over a million yuan. One look and you could tell her family background was extraordinary.

Over time, people started saying Zhao Xuning was their hospital's "flower on a high peak"²—only to be admired from afar, not to be touched.

At this moment, facing Zhao Xuning, everyone felt a bit uneasy.

Zhao Xuning was tactful enough. She only paused briefly before asking: "Who is she with?"

A young nurse said: "Just look out the window and you'll know... That scene is quite beautiful."

Zhao Xuning paused for a moment, pressed her lips together, and said coldly: "Thank you."

After saying this, she didn't look out the window as the young nurse had suggested.

She went all the way back to her office. Only after washing her hands did she stand by the window and casually opened it.

Snowflakes carrying a chill hit her face.

This heavy snow in Haizhou City had been building up with cold air for a long time. When it finally fell, it came down as fluttering, swirling heavy snow.

The ground and rooftops were quickly covered with a thick layer, dyeing the entire world white.

From Zhao Xuning's vantage point, she could see two people walking hand in hand in the heavy snow.

While everyone else was hiding from the snow, their heads, shoulders, and clothes were all covered with white snowflakes.

Zhao Xuning suddenly thought of a phrase: "Frost and snow blown upon our heads—that too counts as reaching white-haired old age together."³

Who had said this to her again?

—It was Shen Hui.

Footnotes:

¹ **"I could die from shipping them" (嗑生嗑死):** Internet slang where "嗑" (kē) means to "ship" a couple (support a romantic pairing). The phrase expresses extreme enthusiasm for a couple, literally meaning "shipping them to life and death"—being so invested in their romance that it consumes you.

² **"Flower on a high peak" (高嶺之花):** A Chinese expression describing someone who is beautiful and admirable but unapproachable, like a flower growing on a high mountain peak that can only be looked at from afar.

³ **"Frost and snow blown upon our heads—that too counts as reaching white-haired old age together" (霜雪吹滿頭，也算到白首):** A poetic phrase playing on the traditional Chinese romantic wish of "growing old together until our hair turns white" (白首). Here, having snow (white) blown onto their heads is likened to achieving that wish of being together until old age, even if temporarily through snowflakes rather than actual aging.

Chapter 132-2

Zhao Xuning reached out to catch a snowflake. The white snow instantly melted into water in her palm, carrying the slight chill of winter.

That year, Haizhou City's snow was the heaviest in recent years. She didn't have morning classes that day. The night before, she had worked on her research project until 2 AM. Before going to sleep, she saw snowflakes starting to fall outside and went back to the room to tuck in the blanket for Shen Hui, who was already fast asleep.

Shen Hui's sleeping posture was really not great—she always kicked off her blankets.

Winter and summer were still okay, but during spring and autumn, especially when the seasons changed, she often caught colds.

When Zhao Xuning was tucking her in, Shen Hui briefly woke up, nuzzled against her face, and asked in a low voice: "You're still not done?"

"Mm." Zhao Xuning kissed her forehead. Her loosely tied hair hung down the sides of her face. "Go back to sleep first."

Then her tone became fierce: "No kicking off the blanket."

Shen Hui chuckled softly, the corners of her lips curving up as she mumbled: "I know."

Then she turned over and fell back into deep sleep.

Zhao Xuning returned to the study and continued working on her research project.

By the time she went to bed, it was almost 4 AM. The snow outside had piled up in a thick layer, illuminating the entire world.

Zhao Xuning carefully got into bed. Her body was cold, but Shen Hui still rolled directly into her arms.

It was just an unconscious movement.

That morning should have been around 7:30. Shen Hui sat on the edge of the bed, constantly scratching at Zhao Xuning's palm. Zhao Xuning was dead tired—she had stayed up all night by the window working on her project and simply couldn't wake up.

Her entire head was buried in her hair, and combined with her morning grumpiness, she was genuinely irritated.

She said hoarsely: "Stop messing around."

But Shen Hui continued anyway, sitting on the edge of the bed and shaking Zhao Xuning's hand. "Wifey, get up."

Zhao Xuning was on the verge of exploding. "Let me sleep a bit more."

"Get up." Shen Hui grabbed Zhao Xuning's hand and put it against her own neck. The cold instantly swept through Zhao Xuning's body. She sat up with her hair all disheveled and called out coldly: "Shen Hui, you..."

She had originally wanted to say "are you annoying or what," but when she saw Shen Hui's clear, limpid eyes—

All the words were swallowed back.

Those eyes were just too beautiful.

She didn't know if it was because she liked Shen Hui so much that she thought those eyes were incomparably beautiful.

No one's eyes could be more beautiful than Shen Hui's.

Light brown pupils would normally appear very cold and aloof, but when she looked over with a hint of grievance, it made you unable to say a single harsh word, for fear she would cry.

Zhao Xuning could only irritably scratch at her own hair, her tone lazy with a bit of complaint and reproach: "What do you want?"

"Come outside with me to see the snow." Shen Hui tugged at her arm. "I want to eat the shrimp dumplings from the South Gate."

"I'll order delivery for you." Zhao Xuning said. "Can we eat at home?"

Shen Hui: ".....No."

When it came to standoffs, Zhao Xuning could never beat Shen Hui.

So after they had been at an impasse for two minutes, Zhao Xuning got so frustrated that she pressed her down on the bed and gave her a long, lingering kiss.

Shen Hui pounded on her in annoyance. "I'll beat you to death."

Zhao Xuning bit her lip. "Are you going to behave?"

Shen Hui bit back, like a wildcat baring its claws. "Behave my ass."

They always had to fool around for a while.

Zhao Xuning endured her headache and got up to accompany her to the South Gate. It was still snowing then.

The fluttering snow fell upon the world just like it was now—most importantly, it fell upon them.

Zhao Xuning had put on the hood of her white down jacket, but Shen Hui pulled it off. The chaotic heavy snow nearly dyed their hair white.

Shen Hui dragged her to take a photo in the snow.

At that time, Shen Hui even complained about her: "Zhao Xuning, your expression is really sour."

Zhao Xuning looked at her helplessly. "How about I drag you out of bed at 5 AM tomorrow to go jogging?"

Shen Hui agreed directly: "Sure, whoever doesn't get up is a dog."

Zhao Xuning: "....."

Zhao Xuning just bit her face.

After she finished biting and pulled away, Shen Hui would pinch her face. "Zhao Doggy, why are you biting people?"

Zhao Xuning was annoyed. "You know perfectly well I can't get up."

Shen Hui always had a good sleep schedule, while Zhao Xuning before meeting Shen Hui had a schedule that was decent compared to her peers, but compared to Shen Hui, it fell far short.

Shen Hui often jogged on the school track. Every day, there were at least three to five people who came to chat her up.

Zhao Xuning had accompanied her for a while too.

Chapter 132-3

Later, when they got home and Shen Hui posted on her QZone¹, the caption she wrote for that photo was: 【Frost and snow blown upon our heads—that too counts as reaching white-haired old age together.】

At that time, Zhao Xuning had asked: "Why 'counts as'? We can grow white-haired together—we just have to wait several decades."

Shen Hui was organizing photos in their couple's album while not forgetting to complain about her: "Zhao Xuning, can you smile when taking photos in the future? You're not even half as good-looking in photos as you usually are."

Zhao Xuning said: "As long as you look good, that's enough."

"That won't do." Shen Hui propped up her chin. "Then people will say you're not good enough for me, and that would make me feel bad."

Zhao Xuning: "....."

Zhao Xuning was always left not knowing whether to laugh or cry by her.

Shen Hui then explained to her: "It's because we're still young now, so we can use this phrase. When we're old, we'll have to use different captions."

Zhao Xuning listened with partial understanding, but her mind was quick. "So this is why you dragged me out of bed early in the morning to see the snow?"

Shen Hui: "....."

"Actually, you didn't want to eat shrimp dumplings at all. You just wanted me to accompany you to see the snow." Zhao Xuning deduced. "Right?"

Shen Hui: "....."

She sheepishly touched her nose. "Actually, Ningning wifey, sometimes you can be less..."

Before the word "smart" could even leave her mouth, she had already been carried to the bed by Zhao Xuning.

Zhao Xuning pressed down on her with absolute dominance, grinding her teeth as she murmured in her ear: "Baby, you're too ob—vi—ous."

Shen Hui looked up at her and blinked.

Zhao Xuning's lips fell upon her eyes, and Shen Hui wrapped her arms around her neck.

Another day of abandon.

On that day of heavy snow, they only went out in the morning.

They didn't even eat lunch, and only ordered crayfish in the evening.

Back then, they always had endless energy and endless little squabbles.

All of which would ultimately end in bed.

Clearly, so much time had already passed—so long that Zhao Xuning couldn't even remember what courses she had that year anymore. But whenever she thought of Shen Hui, those scenes were like they had been painted in vivid colors.

Forever vivid in her mind.

Zhao Xuning stared at the scene below, unhurriedly took out her phone, and snapped a photo.

It was a sky full of heavy snow, but it perfectly framed Liang Shi and Xu Qingzhu walking hand in hand through the blizzard.

She posted on her Moments: 【Frost and snow blown across the sky—we will surely reach white-haired old age together.】

Footnotes:

¹ **QZone (空間)**: Short for QQ Zone, a social networking platform by Tencent where users can post blogs, photos, and status updates. It was extremely popular among Chinese youth, especially in the 2010s, similar to how Facebook or MySpace functioned in Western countries.

Chapter 132-4

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Liang Shi felt like she had been woken up by the cold wind. In her memory, there was howling cold wind, and when she woke up, she discovered it was snowing.

Snowflakes were fluttering down outside. She was still dazed for a few seconds.

Clearly, just yesterday it had been spring. The peach trees outside the residential complex had peach blossoms blooming, and she had even snapped off two branches.

A moment later, her memories gathered back together. She let out a heavy breath while lying in bed.

—She was back.

She couldn't find her phone, so she hurriedly found a jacket in the room, threw it on casually, and left the hospital room.

While running, she discovered this was her own body.

Although the wound from being stabbed by Chen Liuying was still there, it didn't hurt at all. She ran with great strength, not at all like someone who had been in a coma for a long time.

Liang Shi also hadn't expected to see Xu Qingzhu downstairs. At that moment, Xu Qingzhu was walking through the wind and snow with a calm expression, holding a bouquet of yellow sunflowers in her hands. Under the streetlights, she appeared cold and distant.

As if isolated from the world.

Liang Shi's heart tightened.

She called out to Xu Qingzhu, and everything that happened afterward followed her heart.

She wanted to hold Xu Qingzhu, wanted to kiss her.

Even she—someone who normally wouldn't dare to be intimate with Xu Qingzhu in public—in that instant, under the eyes of so many people, embraced Xu Qingzhu and placed a kiss on her lips.

They kissed and embraced as if no one else existed, releasing all the longing they had for each other during these days.

Xu Qingzhu's tears merged with the snow in an instant, dripping onto the ground.

Liang Shi even kissed beneath her eyes, kissing away those tears.

Afterward, as if by unspoken agreement, neither of them said a word.

They walked hand in hand through the hospital. While everyone else was hiding from the wind and snow, they strolled leisurely.

It wasn't until Liang Shi sneezed that Xu Qingzhu came back to her senses.

Xu Qingzhu asked her nervously: "Are you feeling unwell somewhere?"

Liang Shi shook her head.

"Let's go." Xu Qingzhu raised her other hand to brush the snow from the ends of her hair.

"Let's head back."

"Back where?" Liang Shi said. "Don't I still need to complete the discharge procedures?"

Xu Qingzhu nodded. "Back to the hospital room. Zhao Xuning should be working today."

"Come to think of it, I haven't seen her since I woke up." Liang Shi said.

But she had run out as soon as she woke up, so it was normal that she hadn't seen Zhao Xuning.

She had been in a coma day after day—Zhao Xuning couldn't possibly watch over her every single day.

"She's probably busy with other things." Xu Qingzhu walked alongside her toward the building. "Get a full physical examination first. If everything's fine, we can discharge you."

Liang Shi frowned. "That's not necessary, is it? I know my own body."

It wasn't like she had never been sick or injured before.

When filming in the past, she never used stunt doubles. Whether it was wire work or fight scenes, she did everything herself. There had been times when she fell and her knees swelled up.

Wounds would continuously hurt during the healing process—she definitely wouldn't feel the way she did now.

Liang Shi was surprised at the time, but then she remembered that the system had said her physiology would be changed with each deployment to make her become the version of herself in that world.

In other words, this was now her body, but it had also already differentiated—she was an Alpha.

And to avoid being discovered, the wounds on her body were still there, but she couldn't feel any pain from them.

Internally, she was now a completely healthy person. As for those superficial wounds... they would heal slowly.

"The staff who handle discharge procedures have all gotten off work by now. The earliest would be tomorrow morning, so you might as well get an examination before being discharged." Xu Qingzhu said. "I don't have work tomorrow morning."

Liang Shi couldn't win against her, and actually didn't want to either.

She paused for a moment, then nodded in agreement. "Okay."

The two of them returned to the hospital room hand in hand. Liang Shi took off the jacket and hung it by the door. Only then did Xu Qingzhu say: "Your clothes are right there. Why did you wear mine?"

"I didn't see them." Liang Shi had already been settled onto the hospital bed by Xu Qingzhu. "I was too anxious at the time."

"Anxious about what?" Xu Qingzhu was tucking her in with a blanket when Liang Shi grabbed her hand.

A warm hand grasped hers in an instant. Those light brown eyes looked straight at her, carrying a trace of attachment, appearing especially captivating—as if saying: How could you not know?

Xu Qingzhu's hand was cold.

Their eyes met. Liang Shi pulled her toward her, and their lips pressed together again.

But they parted as soon as they touched.

Liang Shi said with a hint of grievance: "How could you not know?"

Xu Qingzhu: ".....How would I know?"

Her tone was indifferent, her eyes lowered, but those eyes held a teasing gleam.

Liang Shi said in a low voice: "I wanted to see you."

Day and night, she thought of her.

Finally, she had arrived in a world with her.

Xu Qingzhu tucked her in with the blanket and wanted Liang Shi to continue lying down. Liang Shi originally didn't want to, but she couldn't win against Xu Qingzhu.

After tucking her in, Xu Qingzhu was about to leave, but Liang Shi instantly sat up and grabbed her hand.

Chapter 132-5

Xu Qingzhu looked puzzled: "Hmm? What is it?"

"What are you doing?" Liang Shi asked. "Why are you leaving?"

"I'm going to call a doctor for you." Xu Qingzhu said. "We should at least do a simple checkup first, so you don't fall into a coma again."

Liang Shi: ".....I really am fine."

But no matter what she said, Xu Qingzhu stubbornly insisted on finding a doctor. Liang Shi became anxious and used too much force, directly pulling Xu Qingzhu to sit on the edge of the bed.

Their eyes met again. Liang Shi sighed helplessly, her eyelashes trembling as she gently closed her eyes.

One of her hands fell on the back of Xu Qingzhu's head as she slowly leaned in.

Xu Qingzhu's hand rested on her waist.

Hard to part, hard to separate.

An Omega's body was softer compared to an Alpha's. Xu Qingzhu was kissed until she lost her sense of direction, her body tilting slightly, about to fall onto the hospital bed together with Liang Shi.

"Ahem, ahem....."

An abrupt, low cough sounded.

Liang Shi instantly snapped out of her dazed, passionate state and immediately separated from Xu Qingzhu.

Only their lips still glistened with moisture.

Zhao Xuning clicked her tongue, took out a pen from her white coat pocket, and teased with a calm expression: "You've got quite a lot of energy right after waking up."

Liang Shi: "....."

Liang Shi's ears and face had already turned red as if she had a fever—absurdly red.

"It's alright." Liang Shi answered sheepishly.

Zhao Xuning scoffed lightly: "Couldn't you wait until you got home?"

Liang Shi: "....."

She was teased by Zhao Xuning until she almost wanted to find a hole to hide in. She had never encountered such a situation before and didn't know how to retort.

Xu Qingzhu had already composed herself and replied to Zhao Xuning without any politeness: "If you got back together with Dr. Shen, you'd definitely be way crazier than us."

Zhao Xuning: ".....?"

"You....." Zhao Xuning looked at Xu Qingzhu. "When did you two become so close?"

Xu Qingzhu shrugged: "Maybe it's beauties attracting each other."

When she said this, her tone was very light, not annoying at all.

Rather, it was convincing. Combined with that face of hers as proof, no one would doubt the truthfulness of her words.

At the mention of Shen Hui, Zhao Xuning lowered her eyes and retorted without much conviction: "That wouldn't happen."

Xu Qingzhu: "Is it that you two wouldn't be crazier than us, or that Dr. Shen wouldn't get back together with you?"

Zhao Xuning: "....."

Liang Shi gave a low cough. "Alright, don't go for the kill."

Zhao Xuning: "....."

"Leave some room when dealing with others, so we can meet again in the future."¹ Liang Shi continued.

Zhao Xuning: "....."

"Are you two tag-teaming to roast me?" Zhao Xuning could clearly tell what was happening. She chuckled lightly. "I interrupted your good time, my mistake. Is that good enough?"

"It's fine. Dr. Zhao is just being diligent and responsible—as she should be." Liang Shi said. "We shouldn't have let Dr. Zhao, a single dog, see such a scene. We....."

Before Liang Shi could finish, Zhao Xuning slapped her on the shoulder, cutting off her words.

"Do you want to stay in the hospital for two more days?" Zhao Xuning threatened.

Liang Shi immediately: "Absolutely not."

Zhao Xuning took out her stethoscope and said while examining her: "You went on a trip and somehow came back more talkative? So many words, so rapid-fire."

Liang Shi: "....."

After Zhao Xuning's follow-up examination, there really were no issues.

But Liang Shi was still hung up on what Zhao Xuning had said earlier. After Zhao Xuning finished the checkup, Liang Shi asked carefully: "Do you all know that I went back?"

"No." Zhao Xuning said. "You went on a long journey."

Zhao Xuning looked at her very seriously and extended her hand toward her: "Liang Shi, welcome home."

Liang Shi was stunned. Hot tears instantly welled up in her eyes.

She slowly reached out and clasped hands with Zhao Xuning. "Thank you, Zhao Xuning."

—Welcome home.

This was a tremendous sense of belonging.

Footnotes:

¹ **"Leave some room when dealing with others, so we can meet again in the future"** (做人留一線，日後好相見): A Chinese proverb advising people to show mercy or restraint in conflicts, as you never know when you might need to interact with that person again. Here, Liang Shi is playfully telling Xu Qingzhu to ease up on teasing Zhao Xuning.

Chapter 132-6

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Having been briefly touched by Zhao Xuning, Liang Shi wanted to treat her to dinner and drinks that evening.

It also happened to be when Zhao Xuning got off work.

The three of them went to a restaurant.

Liang Shi and Xu Qingzhu walked hand in hand, while Zhao Xuning walked alone on the side.

Fortunately, the distance they had to walk wasn't long, otherwise Liang Shi would have felt too sorry for Zhao Xuning.

After entering the private room at the restaurant, Liang Shi handed the menu to Zhao Xuning, letting her order.

But Zhao Xuning raised an eyebrow at her: "Drinking?"

Liang Shi: "....."

"No." Xu Qingzhu said immediately. "If you want to drink, I'll drink with you. She can't drink right now."

Liang Shi: "....."

"So you're here to torture me?" Zhao Xuning chuckled lightly, in a teasing tone.

But Liang Shi detected a hint of bitterness in it.

Xu Qingzhu shook her head and said very seriously: "Her health isn't good."

Liang Shi: ".....It's not."

"I'm a doctor." Zhao Xuning said. "Don't I know whether her health is good or not, whether she can drink or not?"

Liang Shi: "....."

"Miss Liang." Zhao Xuning poured Liang Shi a glass of wine. "I hope you can use your actions to change your wife's stereotypical impression of you."

Liang Shi: "?"

With the conversation going this far, who couldn't tell this was a suggestive joke?¹

However, Zhao Xuning was subtle—even when making this kind of joke, she was very restrained.

It didn't make anyone feel uncomfortable.

But it did give Liang Shi a sense of danger in her heart.

Because she didn't know where they would accelerate this conversation to, and it even felt like they could veer off course at any moment.

Liang Shi subconsciously pinched her earlobe, feeling slightly embarrassed.

"Oh, come on." Liang Shi glanced at Zhao Xuning. "Are you jealous? If you've got the ability, go get married too."

Zhao Xuning chuckled lightly and took a sip of wine, shrugging indifferently.

But then they heard Xu Qingzhu say while propping up her chin: "Dr. Zhao, you don't know."

Alarm bells went off in Liang Shi's heart.

Xu Qingzhu also took a sip of wine and said leisurely: "Miss Liang really can't do it."

Liang Shi: "....."

"Hey." Liang Shi tugged at her hand under the table.

Zhao Xuning raised an eyebrow with great interest: "Oh?"

Xu Qingzhu: "She admitted it herself. She can't do it."

Liang Shi: "?"

Footnotes:

¹ **Suggestive joke (開黃腔):** Literally "making yellow remarks"—in Chinese, "yellow" (黃) is associated with sexual or adult content. This refers to making risqué or sexually suggestive jokes. Zhao Xuning is implying that Liang Shi should prove her physical capabilities (in an intimate sense) to change Xu Qingzhu's impression of her health.